RAHEL KESSETE AFEWERKY
Western Michigan University, Department of Political Science
rahelkessete.afewerky@wmich.edu/rahelkessete@gmail.com

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Political Science *Expected* Spring 2027
Western Michigan University, Kalamazoo, MI, USA
Fields: Comparative Politics, International Relations, and Political Theory
Dissertation Title: Silenced to Compliance: The Absence of Popular Protests in Authoritarian Eritrea (1998-2023)
Committee: Dr. Emily Hauptmann (Chair); Dr. Yuan-Kang Wang; Dr. David Siegel (Duke University)
Award: WMU Dissertation Completion Fellowship (2026-2027)

M.A., Political Science
Western Michigan University, Kalamazoo, MI, USA

M.A., International Relations
Marmara University, Istanbul, Turkey

B.A., Political Science and International Relations
Adi Keih College of Arts and Social Sciences, Eritrea

PUBLICATIONS (Selected)

Peer-Reviewed Publications:

- Afewerky, R. K. (2023). Residual Responsibility to Implement: the AU, the Constitutive Act, and the Responsibility to Protect. *Global Responsibility to Protect*, 16(2), 127-149

- Afewerky, R. K. (2022). Darfur: R2P and Dilemmas of Implementation. In *The Responsibility to Protect Twenty Years On: Rhetoric and Implementation*, Cham: Springer International Publishing. 33-53

Working Papers:

- Why Protest? The Anatomy of "Genuine" Popular Protests and Their Role in Ushering in Democratic Change (Best Paper Award, 56th MIPSA Conference)

- The Controversy Behind The Istanbul Convention: The Role of Ruling Parties in the Fight to End Violence Against Women and Domestic Violence in Poland and Turkey

- Writing on and about Authoritarian Regimes: The Case of Eritrea

TEACHING EXPERIENCE (Selected)

As Instructor

Modern Political Thought	Fall 25
International Relations	Summer I 23, Spring 24, Summer I 24, Fall 24, Summer II 25, Spring 26

As a Teaching Assistant:

Data in Politics and Policy	Spring 25
Public Policy and the Economy	Spring 25
Modern Political Thought	Fall 23
International Relations	Spring 23
Comparative Politics	Fall 22
Women and Politics	Spring 22
Environmental Politics	Fall 21

HONORS AND AWARDS (Selected)

Internal (WMU)

- WMU Dissertation Completion Fellowship (2026-2027)
- College of Arts & Sciences Summer Graduate Research Development Grant (2025 & 26)
- Department Graduate Teaching Effectiveness Award, WMU (2026)
- Graduate Student Research Grant, WMU (Spring 2026)
- Graduate Student Travel Grant, WMU (Fall 2025)
- Department Travel Grant (Spring 2022, Spring 2023, Spring 2024, Fall 2025, Fall 2026)
- All-University Graduate Research and Creative Scholar Award, WMU (2024)
- Howard Wolpe Scholarship Award in Political Science (2024, 2025, and 2026)
- Department Graduate Research and Creative Scholar Award, WMU (2023)
- Robert Kleiner Memorial Scholarship sponsored by WMU-AAUP (2022)
- John R. Borsos Memorial Endowed Scholarship, WMU (2021 and 2022)

External

- 122nd American Political Science Association Annual Conference Travel Grant (2026)
- 66th Annual International Studies Association Convention Travel Grant (2025)
- Best Paper Award, 56th Annual Michigan Political Science Association Conference (2024)
- Empirical Implications of Theoretical Models Certification (2024)
- Inter-university Consortium for Political and Social Research (ICPSR) Summer Program Scholarship (Fully Funded, Summer 2024)
- Erasmus Mundus Internship Grant, Tactics Institute for Security and Counter-Terrorism (Summer 21)
- Erasmus Mundus Exchange Scholarship, Sapienza University of Rome, Italy (Spring 21)
- Turkish Government Scholarship (Türkiye Bursları) (2016-2021)
- Medal of Honors (Very Great Distinction), Adi Keih College of Arts and Social Sciences, Adi Keih, Eritrea

RESEARCH AND TEACHING WORKSHOP/TRAINING (Selected)

- Inter-university Consortium for Political and Social Research (ICPSR), University of Michigan (Summer 2024)
- Institute for Qualitative and Multi-Method Research (IQMR), Syracuse University (Summer 2023)
- WMUx Professional Development Series Training by WMUx Office of Faculty Development and Instructional Design, WMU (Summer 2022 and 2024)

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

- American Political Science Association
- International Studies Association
- Midwest Political Science Association
- Michigan Political Science Association
- Pi Sigma Alpha, the National Political Science Honor Society

CONFERENCE & WORKSHOP PRESENTATIONS (Selected)

- American Political Science Association Conference 2026
- International Studies Association 2025, 2026
- Michigan Political Science Association Conference 2024
- Midwest Political Science Conference 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025
- Responsibility to Protect in Theory and Practice Conference 20 Years, UK 2021

SKILLS

- Programming Languages: R, Python, Excel, and LATEX
- Languages: Tigrinya (Native Speaker), Turkish (Fluent); French (Beginner)

SERVICE TO THE COMMUNITY (Selected)

- Office of Faculty Development, WMU: Panelist, Graduate Teaching Assistant Training session, 2026
- Women of Color in Political Science Biennial Pre-Conference (held at the American Political Science Association Annual Meeting): Organizing Team Member (team led by Dr. Sharon Austin, University of Florida) and Moderator, 2026
- International Studies Association, 67th Annual Convention: Volunteer, On-Site, 2026
- ICPSR Summer Program, University of Michigan: Opportunity Scholar Mentor, 2025
- Midwest Political Science Association, Annual Conference: Discussant, 2022
- WMU: International Student Orientation Leadership Program, Spring and Summer 2022

REFERENCES

Dr. Emily Hauptmann
Professor, Department of Political Science
Western Michigan University
emily.hauptmann@wmich.edu
(269) 387-5695

Dr. David Siegel
Professor, Department of Political Science and Pu
Duke University
david.siegel@duke.edu
(919) 660-4300

Dr. Kevin Corder
Professor, Department of Political Science
Western Michigan University
j.kevin.corder@wmich.edu
(269) 387-5697

Dr. Yuan-Kang Wang
Professor, Department of Political Science
Western Michigan University
yuan-kang.wang@wmich.edu
(269) 387-5701